

openSUSE Leap 42.1: The Linux Distro You will Love



The all new openSUSE Leap distro should present no problems for installation even to newbies. In this article, the author narrates his first hand experiences while installing the distro. He also gives the reader a quick evaluation of the distro, installation advice and how to overcome various snags.

On November 4, 2015, the openSUSE project released a new version of openSUSE Linux, openSUSE Leap 42.1, after exactly one year. This release has some very big changes. The openSUSE core is now based on SUSE Enterprise Linux (SLE) and future releases will be in sync with SLE. openSUSE Tumbleweed is a rolling release distribution, which contains cutting-edge but stable packages. With Leap, the openSUSE project is targeting enterprise workstations and servers. It is also suitable for people looking for long term stability and less frequent update(s). In other words, it is trying to compete with Ubuntu LTS releases and CentOS-like distros. It comes with kernel 4.1 (LTS series, 4.1.12), GNOME 3.16.4 (the latest is 3.18) and KDE 5.4.2. The default is GCC 4.8.5 but GCC 5 can be installed from official repos. For those looking for cutting-edge packages, Tumbleweed is the right choice.

Installation

For installation, I usually download the KDE live CD and write that to a USB drive using the *rufus* (<https://rufus.akeo.ie>) utility. Unfortunately, this time only the DVD is available. Downloading the DVD takes four to five hours on my 2Mbps connection. And saving it on a USB stick, or writing it to a DVD and installing it will take another hour or more. You can use the openSUSE 42.1 DVD bundled with this issue of *OSFY* magazine to get started. I decided to try

a network installation. For those who do not have the DVD, the net install ISO is about 80MB, so it can be downloaded quickly. I wrote it to a USB stick using *rufus* and booted from it. You can find a detailed installation guide at <https://en.opensuse.org/Portal:42.1>

Before going further, let me tell you about my hardware. It is a five year old laptop, the processor is AMD Phenom II X4 N 930, with 6GB RAM, with dual graphics (Radeon HD 4250 and 2GB Radeon HD 5420). I connected the laptop to the Internet using Wi-Fi, and set up the network configuration to DHCP at the first screen. I was not able to connect to the Internet. The error message stated that the DHCP request had failed. So I connected the laptop to the modem through a network cable and started the installation.

Once the graphical Yast installer is loaded, the steps are the same as a DVD installation. There is no change in the installer. After selecting the language, keyboard and configuring partitions, it shows a nice summary of items. Here, the user can check different items, so don't forget to check where Grub is being installed — it must be MBR. Since I was doing a network installation, I de-selected some packages like LibreOffice, the Gimp, etc, to save some time, with plans to install them later. Downloading and installing packages took about 100 minutes (lesson learnt: a 2Mbps connection is not good enough for online installation).

The installation went smoothly without any hiccups. All